

Exhibit 18

The Evening Standard - The F Factor_ The tech competition looking to find the
entrepreneurs of the future

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The F Factor: The tech competition looking to find the entrepreneurs of the future

Pitch your life-changing idea to some of the biggest names in tech to win £10,000 in funding



KIKE ONIWINDE WON THE F FACTOR IN 2018 FOR HER START-UP BYP NETWORK
F FACTOR

[AMELIA HEATHMAN](#)

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Have the idea for the perfect start-up? If you're aged between 14 and 25 then you can enter your ground-breaking concept into The F Factor and have the chance to pitch your start-up to some of the biggest names in tech.

The F Factor was launched by Founders of the Future, part of the [Founders Forum](#) network set up by Lastminute.com's [Brent Hoberman](#), as a way to find the next generation of entrepreneurial talent who will lead the future of tech.

Now in its fifth year, the competition has been revamped in order to give young people across the country a voice and a chance to show off their vision for the future.

There are now two age categories to give everyone a fairer judging process: one for those aged 14-18 years old, and one for those aged 19-25 years old.



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There are also four rounds to the competition now with online qualifiers, regional heats and finals, plus the national final, which will take place in June at the annual Founders Forum event in London. The regional breakdown sees London as its own region, as well as the South East and the South West, North East and North West, Northern Ireland and Scotland, and the Midlands.

The entry date for the online rounds has been extended until March 17. Liam Tootill, who runs Founders of the Future alongside Pierre-Simon Ntiruhungwa, told the *Standard*: “Founders of the Future has extended the deadline to apply for its national start-up competition, The F Factor, until midnight Sunday, March 17. This gives us more time to deliver workshops in secondary schools up and down the country as we embark on our mission to unearth the future founders of tomorrow, who are building tech-enabled solutions to some of the world's toughest challenges.

“Back in its fifth edition, but with a brand new format, this year's event will be bigger and better than ever as we are across two age categories, five regions of the UK, and across four knock-out stages.”



JACK CORNES AND HARRY SMITH WON THE F FACTOR IN 2017 FOR THEIR HAUSBOTS START-UP F FACTOR

In order to enter, you need to come up with an idea relating to tackling one of the [UN's Sustainable Development Goals](#), using a technological solution. This means it could relate to ending poverty, providing affordable and clean energy across the globe, or reducing inequality.

Once you submit your application, you will then get access to resources and a toolkit to help you refine your idea and pitch.

The winners will receive £10,000 equity free funding, as well as internship and mentorship opportunities. They will also become part of the Founders Forum network, which includes names such as Sir Richard Branson, Natalie Massenet of Net-a-Porter, and Sarah Wood, co-founder and co-CEO at Unruly. It's an incredible opportunity for a young person to pitch their ideas to some of the most important people in the tech industry.

Kiki Oniwinde won last year's competition for her business [BYP Network](#), a network for young black professionals. She told the *Standard*: "The F Factor provided me the opportunity, as a young woman from Dagenham, to talk about being black and why the narrative must be changed. I pitched my business, BYP Network, to a crowd of over 350 business leaders at the Founders Forum; and won. That was a moment for me to understand that my ideas are valid and I can be the change I want to see in the world."

Since winning The F Factor last year, BYP Network has raised £150,000 in pre-seed funding and is also [supported by Sky](#) and the New Entrepreneurs Foundation.

“It’s important for young people from disadvantaged backgrounds to enter competitions like the F Factor because they provide an opportunity for their business ideas to be validated,” Oniwinde added.

Jake Cornes won The F Factor in 2017, alongside his friend Harry Smith, for [Hausbots](#), a start-up focused on creating construction robots. Their first robot can paint walls autonomously. He told the Standard: “F Factor was, is and forever will be one of the defining moments of our career. Winning the prize money catapulted our business forward, allowing us to achieve important milestones such as applying for a patent, but not only that, the relationships we have built with the high calibre of people will be life long and life-changing.”

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